Westward Expansion 3-1: Railroads, Homesteads & the Plains Bartonian ID _____

Write neatly ■ Boxes are reserved for *final answers only* ■ *Bartonian ID* must be written on each page ■ Do not staple.

1) In 1862, Congress passed a law offering settlers 160 acres of public land at almost no cost, provided they lived on the claim and improved it for five years. Name this law.

1

2) Before the railroads crossed the Plains, most westbound pioneers purchased wagons, oxen, and supplies in one of two "jumping-off" towns along the Missouri River, both located in Missouri. Name one of these two towns.

2

3) On May 10, 1869, the Union Pacific and Central Pacific lines met in Utah Territory, where a golden spike completed the first transcontinental railroad. Name the location where the two lines were joined.

3

4) In 1879, tens of thousands of African Americans left the South for Kansas, drawn by the promise of cheap land and escape from violence and sharecropping. What name did these migrants give themselves, drawn from the biblical book of Exodus?

4

5) Ranchers moved enormous herds of Texas longhorns north along routes such as the Chisholm Trail to reach railhead "cow towns" like Abilene, Kansas. What two-word term describes these overland journeys?

5

6) The Dawes Act of 1887 dissolved communal ownership of tribal land and divided reservations into individual parcels assigned to heads of household. What term did the act use for these individual parcels of land?

6

7) In 1870, an estimated 15 million of these animals still roamed the Great Plains; by the mid-1880s, commercial hunting had brought them to the edge of extinction, devastating the Plains nations whose food, shelter, and trade depended on them. Name the animal.

7

Numbers 8-9 must be answered in complete sentences (2-3 sentences each).

8) Explain how the completion of the transcontinental railroad changed life on the Great Plains for both white settlers and Native American nations. Address both groups in your answer.

8

9) The Homestead Act advertised "free land," yet a large share of homesteaders abandoned their claims within a few years. Identify and explain two reasons that farming on the Plains proved far harder than settlers expected.

9